PANDORA

THE PULL ENGINE

A strategy perspective for Digital & Technology

Prepared in connection with the role of Senior Manager, Strategy & Transformation, D&T

Lars Glade · Copenhagen · August 2026

THE STARTING POINT — HARD NUMBERS

Phoenix built the machine.
The numbers say the next phase is different.

DKK 32.5bn

Revenue 2025 — the world's largest jewellery brand, 7,000 points of sale

2%

Organic growth Q1 2026 — North America and Western Europe LFL both at −2%

20.9%

Q1 2026 EBIT margin — despite 440bp of external headwinds. Current Q2 LFL: ~flat

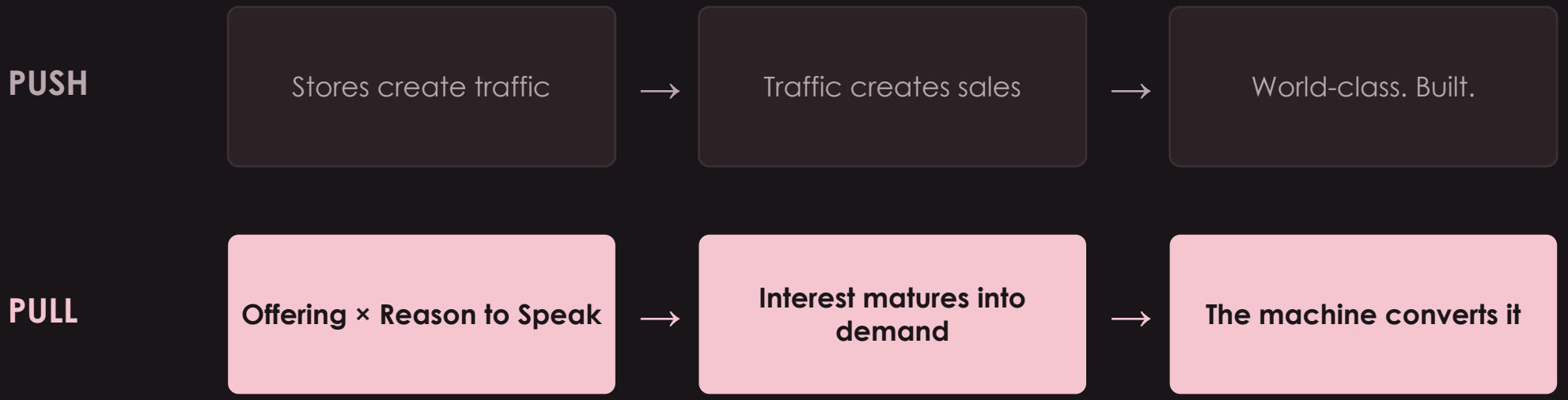
21–22%

EBIT margin guidance 2026, vs. a prior ambition of at least 24%

CMD 2023 promised 7–9% CAGR and 26–27% EBIT by 2026 — an implied ~DKK 34–36bn top line. The current trajectory leaves an annual gap of roughly DKK 2–3bn revenue and ~DKK 2bn EBIT. That gap is the mandate.

THE THESIS

Pandora mastered push.
The next phase is pull — and pull is digital.



Digital & Technology is where pull is manufactured.

FIRST PRINCIPLES

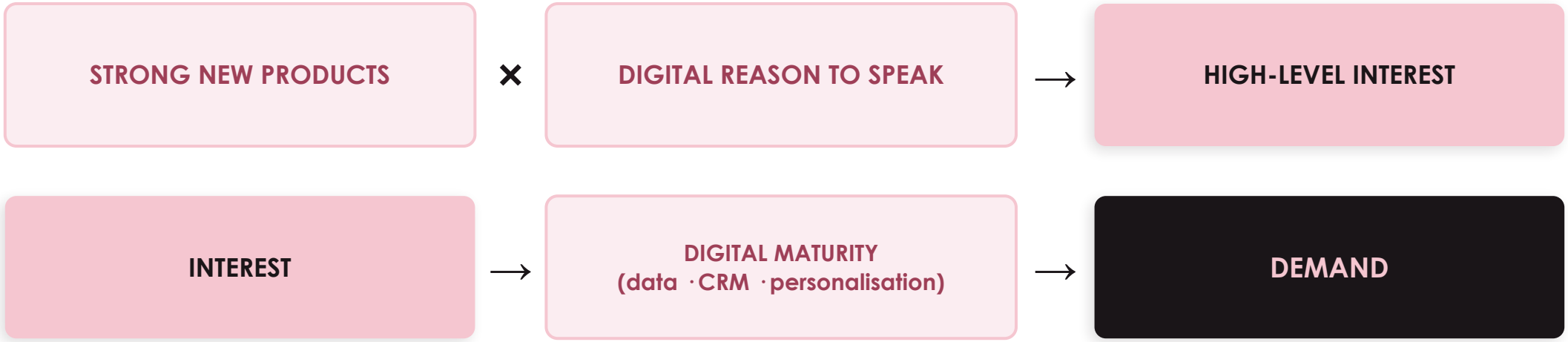
Growth is multiplicative. The weakest link sets the ceiling.

DESIRABILITY × **DISCOVERY** × **CONVERSION** × **REPEAT** = **GROWTH**

- A brilliant store network cannot compensate for weak digital discovery — the terms multiply, they do not add.
- Pandora's own next evolution names the first term: design-led desirability, local relevance, calibrated growth engines.
- D&T owns the middle of the chain: discovery, conversion and repeat run on data, CRM and AI.

THE MECHANISM

How pull is manufactured: Offering × Reason to Speak



- The Offering delivers the WHAT: design-led new expressions, new materials, collaborations — desirability made concrete.
- The Reason to Speak delivers the WHY NOW. Concretely: a December bracelet buyer has an anniversary, a gifting window and an unfinished collection on file — the CRM opens the dialogue two weeks before the moment, not after the search.
- Digital maturity converts interest into demand at scale — and measures it against control. Neither factor works alone: the multiplication holds here too.

THE AGENDA

Three priorities for Digital & Technology

01

Demand infrastructure

Turn the data foundation into a desirability engine: personalisation, CRM and digital discovery that create demand before the store visit.

02

AI — from pilots to P&L

Scale the Clara precedent beyond service. Every AI initiative gets a baseline, a control and a P&L number — or it stops.

03

A strategy-to-execution OS

One operating system from strategy to portfolio to delivery to measured value — so ambition survives contact with the organisation.

Priority 03 is the mandate of this role — it is what makes 01 and 02 land.

PRIORITY 01

Demand infrastructure: from transaction data to desirability signals

- The foundation exists. S/4HANA, cloud migration and the new e-commerce platform rolling out through 2025–26 mean the constraint is no longer plumbing — it is commercial application.
- Reason to Speak at jewellery's emotional cadence. Gifting moments, life events and collection logic are predictable — the CRM should open the dialogue with a legitimate occasion, before the customer searches.
- Digital discovery as the first store visit. For the next cohort of buyers, the brand is met on a screen before a street — the funnel starts in D&T's systems.
- One demand P&L. Digitally created demand measured end-to-end — including what converts in stores, where most of it will. The principle: incrementality via geo- and hold-out tests where possible, modelled attribution elsewhere — always with a control.

PRIORITY 02

AI: from pilots to P&L

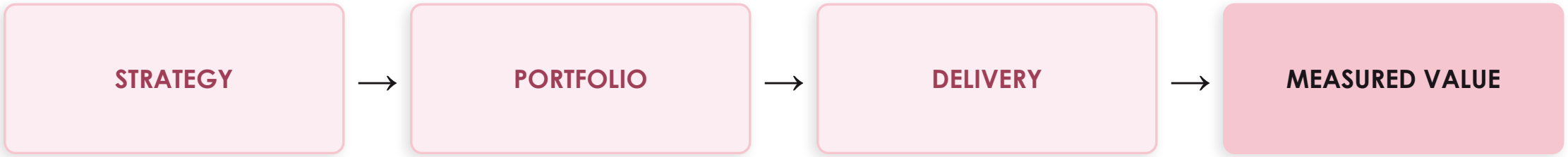
Clara proved the pattern in customer service. The strategy question is not whether AI works — it is which function is next, and how fast the pattern scales.

Pick the function → Set the baseline → Deploy against control → **Measure the P&L delta** → Scale — or stop

- Candidate order by value density: demand forecasting & allocation, merchandising and pricing, marketing content operations, store workforce planning.
- The transformation job is organisational, not technical: adoption, leadership capability and new ways of working — exactly the change mandate of this role.

PRIORITY 03

One operating system from strategy to measured value



↺ *what the measurement shows feeds the next strategy cycle*

- Fewer, bigger bets: a portfolio ranked by expected P&L impact, not by sponsor seniority.
- Every strategic project carries three things from day one: an executive owner, a governance cadence and a falsifiable success measure.
- Communication is part of the system, not an afterthought — townhalls, director forums and narratives are how strategy becomes behaviour.

FROM PERSPECTIVE TO PLAN

The first 18 months

MONTHS 1–3

Governance

Stand up the operating system. Audit the portfolio against P&L criteria. Mandate control groups. Stop what fails the test.

MONTHS 4–6

Demand infrastructure

Predictive Reason to Speak models live before peak trading. One unified demand P&L across channels.

MONTHS 7–12

AI scaling

Forecasting, pricing, merchandising, store staffing — each deployed against control, each with a margin number.

MONTHS 13–18

Enterprise scale

AI decisions embedded in S/4HANA workflows. The proof point: measurable LFL recovery and margin resilience.

Risks are governed, not hoped away: commercial buy-in → the demand P&L is co-designed with Retail and Merchandising · data quality & identity resolution → audited in Phase 1 · EU AI Act & GDPR → compliance built into the OS · legacy-project resistance → the stop-list.

THE DISCIPLINE

Every initiative gets a number and a control group.

Strategy that cannot be falsified is not strategy — it is decoration.

Three rules: state the expected effect before launch · measure against a control, not against last year · kill what does not move the number, scale what does.

THE TEAM OF FIVE

Four portfolios, one logic: leverage over volume

Digital strategy	Owns the D&T strategy cycle and the demand-infrastructure agenda
AI transformation	Runs the pilot-to-P&L pattern and the adoption programme
Organisational transformation	Operating model, ways of working, leadership capability
Executive support	CDTO and DTLT material, forums, narratives — decision quality as a product

Not a parallel structure: the team works through Merchandising, Marketing and Retail — five people cannot out-produce the organisation, but they can out-leverage it.

WHY THIS ARGUMENT COMES FROM ME

I have run this play — and measured it.

+19,000

incremental sales at YouSee — ~ €10M annual revenue, documented against control groups

€5–8M

incremental sales at Topdanmark/If — churn cut from 18–19% to 12–13% on key segments

4 years

leading an in-house strategy function at Fullrate — +DKK 50M new revenue

30 years

of commercial P&L leadership — strategy, transformation and execution in one person

The YouSee play — Reason to Speak in the base, measured against control — is the Pandora play at larger scale.

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